Arul Murugan

Contact

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Education

University of California, Berkeley
Master of Information Management and Systems — 2025 – Present

BITS Pilani, K. K. Birla Goa Campus
B.E., Chemical Engineering (First Division) — 2018 – 2022

Research Interests

Computational social science; LLM multi-agent simulation; strategic interactions and collective behavior; model interpretability and steering; economic and societal impacts of frontier AI.

Publications

Simulating Strategic Interactions with AI Agents
Matteo Tranchero, Cecil-Francis Brenninkmeijer, **Arul Murugan**, & Abhishek Nagaraj
Strategic Management Journal, 2026

Working Papers

The Jagged Global Economy: Frontier AI Unevenly Exposes National Economies
Arul Murugan, Tomás Aguirre, Abhishek Nagaraj, & Rishi Bommasani
Preprint, 2026

Interpreting and Steering LLM Agents for Social Simulations
Jiayue Gaveal Fan, **Arul Murugan**, Shreyas Krishnan, & Abhishek Nagaraj
Preprint, 2026

Workshop Papers

GlobeBench: Source-Grounded Evaluation of Local Geographic Assistance
Shreyas Krishnan, **Arul Murugan**, & Abhishek Nagaraj
Poster, *GenAI4World Workshop*, COLM, 2026

The Verification Bottleneck: Managing Trust in Post-AGI Science
Arul Murugan
Poster, *Post-AGI Science and Society Workshop*, ICLR, 2026

Silicon Reviewers: Simulating Expert Panels to Test Funding Mechanisms
Arul Murugan, Saqib Mumtaz, & Abhishek Nagaraj
Poster, *Post-AGI Science and Society Workshop*, ICLR, 2026

Research Experience

Economics of Frontier AI Group, Stanford University
Student Researcher — 2026
With *Rishi Bommasani*

Data Innovation and AI Lab, UC Berkeley
Student Researcher — 2025 – Present
Research Fellow — 2024 – 2025
With *Abhishek Nagaraj and Matteo Tranchero*

Cognitive Neuroscience Lab, BITS Pilani Goa
Student Researcher — 2022
With *Veeky Baths*

Queen Mary University of London
Research Intern — 2021
With *Vimal Balasubramaniam*

Teaching

Graduate Student Instructor, COMPSS 211A: Computing I
Computational Social Science, UC Berkeley — Fall 2026
Instructor: Tom van Nuenen. GSI effectiveness: TBD.

Graduate Student Instructor, EWMBA 295T: AI for Business Leaders
Haas School of Business, UC Berkeley — Spring 2026
Instructor: Abhishek Nagaraj. GSI effectiveness: 6.6/7.

Talks

Human-AI Complementarity Workshop: Dynamic Alignment, CMU — Fall 2026
Spotlight: The Crowd in the Loop: Can Verified Community Advice Improve Human–AI Coordination?

Industry Experience

Photon Insights, Inc., Founding Engineer — 2022 – 2024
Built the MVP alongside the founder, helping raise $2 million.

Woodstock Fund, Research Intern — 2022

BrightCHAMPS, Associate Product Manager Intern — 2021

WorldQuant LLC, Research Consultant — 2019

Media

PCMag, Interview — 2024
Mod Life: What It Takes to Keep r/ChatGPT's 5 Million Members in Check

Grants

UC Berkeley I School: Impact and Innovation Internship Grant ($7,000) — 2026
UC Berkeley I School: Master's Conference Travel Grant ($1,500) — 2026
UC Berkeley Graduate Division: Conference Travel Grant ($1,500) — 2026
Pangram Labs: API research credits ($5,000) — 2026
Thinking Machines Lab: Tinker Research Grant ($5,000 in API credits) — 2025
OpenAI: API Credits Grant ($25,000); Co-PI: Abhishek Nagaraj — 2024

References

Abhishek Nagaraj
Associate Professor
UC Berkeley
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Rishi Bommasani
Senior Research Scholar
Stanford University
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Matteo Tranchero
Assistant Professor
University of Pennsylvania
mtranc@wharton.upenn.edu